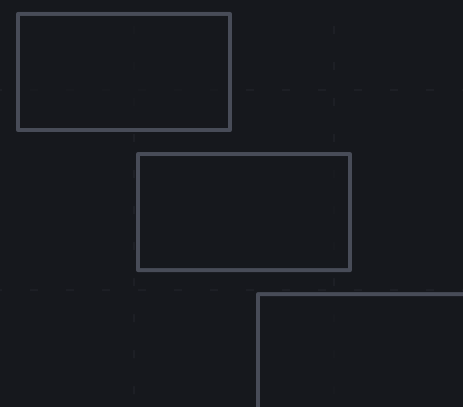


The model is not your observability layer.

If you cannot explain the retrieval or tool trace,
you cannot debug the answer.



SWIPE >

01

Record the boundary, not just the result.

A final answer hides the decision
that produced it.

TRACE

input → decision → effect

Every failure leaves a different trace.

CONCEPT

The same wrong answer can start with stale data or a bad tool call.

MECHANISM

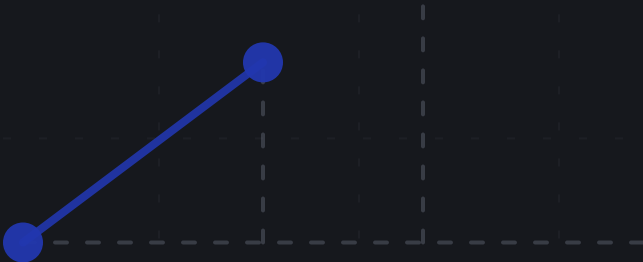
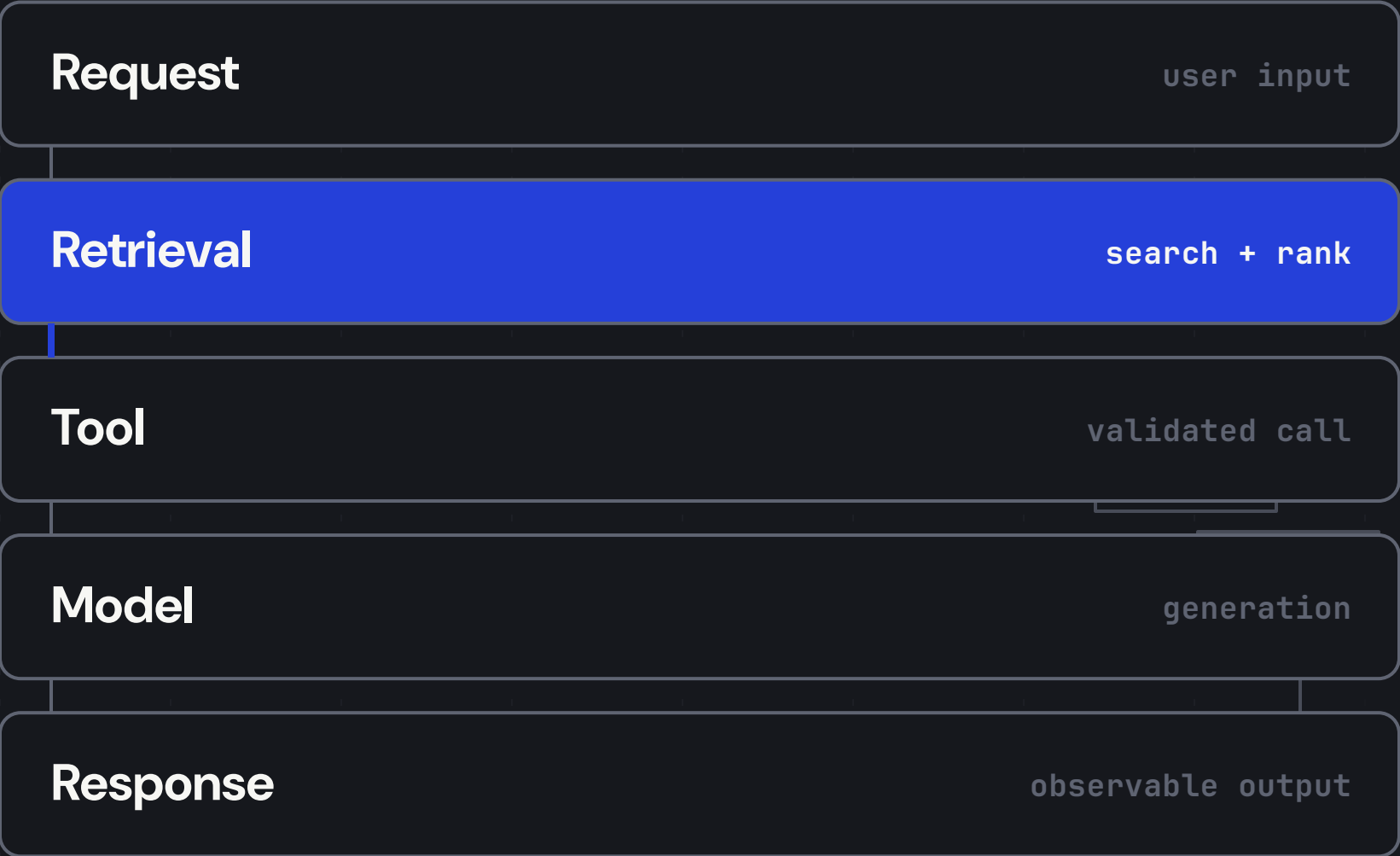
Log the handoff between each system boundary.

TAKEAWAY

Observability is part of the system design, not an afterthought.

One trace. Five boundaries.

The cobalt path is the first place to inspect.



Contracts are cheaper than retries.

```
{  
  "name": "search_docs",  
  "arguments": {  
    "query": "refund policy",  
    "top_k": 5  
  }  
}
```

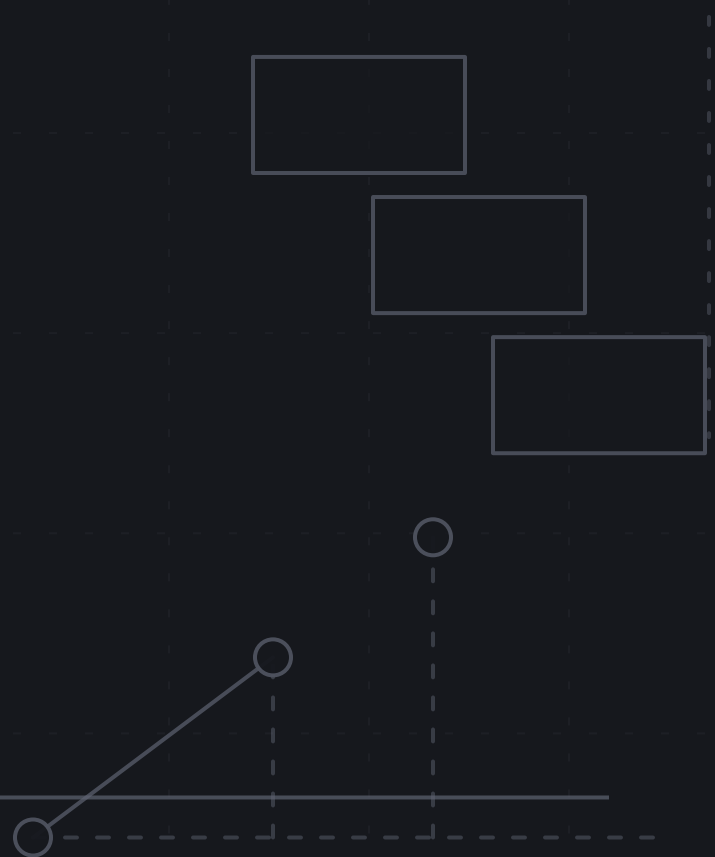
Validate the payload before it crosses the next boundary.



Log the path. Then improve the system.

A better trace gives you a better
debugging surface.

Build the trace you wish you had.



M. Ahsan Izhar

Software Engineering x AI Integration